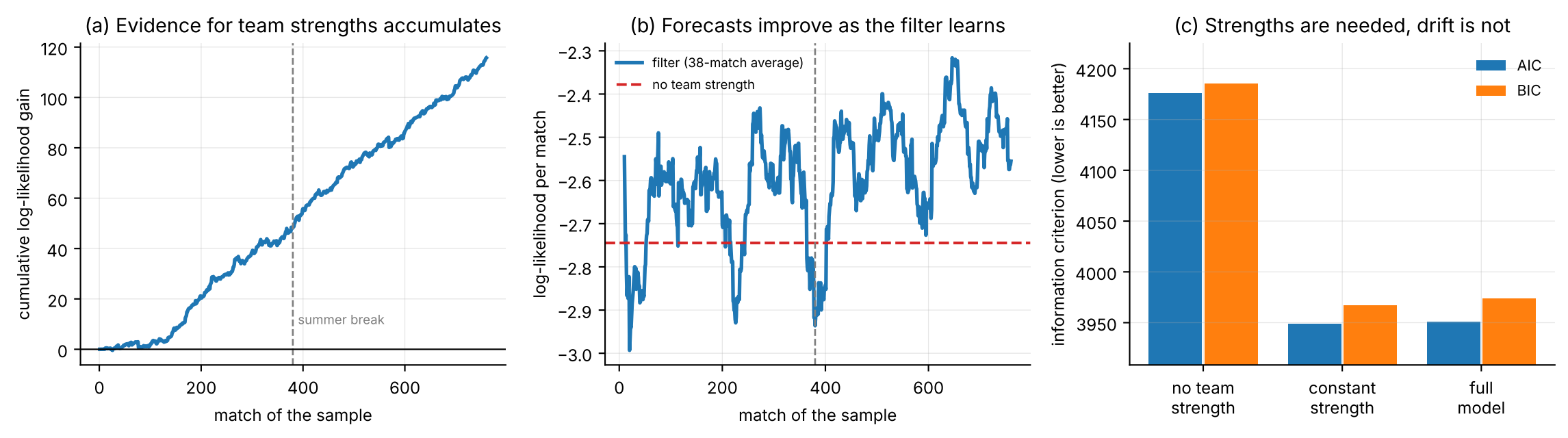
(a) Evidence for team strengths accumulates
cumulative log-likelihood gain
120
100
80
60
40
20
0
summer break
0
200
400
600
match of the sample
(b) Forecasts improve as the filter learns
log-likelihood per match
−2.3
−2.4
−2.5
−2.6
−2.7
−2.8
−2.9
−3.0
filter (38-match average)
no team strength
0
200
400
600
match of the sample
(c) Strengths are needed, drift is not
information criterion (lower is better)
4200
4150
4100
4050
4000
3950
AIC
BIC
no team strength
constant strength
full model